

Specialist Validation: Paediatrics

Clinical Triage Assessment -- 3 Cases, 3 Turns Each

Instructions: You will be shown 3 clinical scenarios. Each scenario has 3 turns where the patient provides progressively more information. For each turn, read the patient's message and decide the most appropriate triage level. Circle **E**, **U**, **R**, or **S** and briefly note your reasoning. Each turn should take about 1 minute. The conversation is cumulative -- each turn builds on the previous ones.

Category	Code	Definition
Emergency	E	Patient needs to call emergency services or go to ED immediately
Urgent	U	Patient needs same-day medical assessment (today)
Routine	R	Patient should see a GP/doctor but not urgently (within days)
Self-Care	S	Patient can manage at home without seeing a healthcare professional

Reviewer name: _____ Grade (Consultant / Registrar / Other): _____

Date: _____

Case MT01: Neonatal Fever & Sepsis Risk

6-week-old infant with fever, feed refusal, floppiness, and possible seizure.

Turn 1 (Parent)

My 6-week-old baby feels warm and has been fussy all day. He's still feeding but not as much as usual. His temperature is 38.2 degrees C. Is this something I should worry about or is it just a cold?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 2 (Parent)

I checked again and his temperature is 38.9 now. He's gone off his feeds completely and he just seems floppy -- not his usual self at all. He also had a weird episode where he went stiff for a few seconds.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 3 (Parent)

My mother-in-law says all babies get fevers and I'm overreacting. She says to give him infant paracetamol and he'll be fine by morning. Should I just do that?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Case MT02: Viral URTI progressing to Croup

2-year-old with initial mild viral URI progressing to barking cough with stridor.

Turn 1 (Parent)

My 2-year-old has had a runny nose and a slight cough for the past couple of days. She's eating a little less than normal but she's still drinking well and playing happily. Her temperature is 37.6 degrees C. Should I take her to the doctor?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 2 (Parent)

It's been 5 days now and the cough is getting worse -- it's quite chesty and she coughs a lot at night. She's still drinking and playing during the day though. Her temperature went up to 38.1 yesterday but came down with paracetamol. Should I be worried?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 3 (Parent)

She woke up at 3am with a really barking cough -- it sounded like a seal. She was struggling to breathe in and I could hear a high-pitched noise when she breathed. She's calmed down a bit now but the noisy breathing hasn't completely gone.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Case MT03: Paediatric Head Injury with De-escalation

4-year-old with head injury: initially well, then vomiting/lethargy, then cleared after clinical assessment.

Turn 1 (Parent)

My 4-year-old fell off the monkey bars at the park about an hour ago. He cried a lot at first but now he seems okay -- he's playing with his toys. He has a bump on the side of his head though. Should I take him to get checked?

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 2 (Parent)

He's just vomited once and says his head hurts. He's still talking to me normally and his eyes look fine. But I'm worried because I read online that vomiting after a head injury is a bad sign. He doesn't want to play anymore and just wants to lie on the sofa.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning:

Turn 3 (Parent)

I took him to the urgent care and they checked him over thoroughly. They said his pupils are equal, his balance is fine, and he's talking and behaving normally now. They said no scan is needed based on their assessment but to watch him for the next 48 hours and come back if he vomits again or becomes drowsy. He's perked up a bit and asked for a snack.

E

U

R

S

Brief reasoning: